

HUNTING A MAMMOTH

A herd of mammoths is passing through Dolní Věstonice. This is good news! A mammoth can feed a large number of people. However, catching one is difficult—people can easily be killed by a swinging tusk or stamping foot. Today, a group of hunters and their dogs are brave enough to try their luck.



7 Reindeer

Herds of reindeer graze on the hills. They would be good to eat if the mammoth escapes.

8 Settlement

The hunters live in homes grouped together in a small village for protection.



Mammoth beasts

As this reconstructed mammoth skeleton shows, mammoths were bigger than modern elephants, with much longer tusks. Females and their offspring lived together in herds.

Hunting spear

Hunters are likely to have used small pieces of flint inserted into an ivory or bone handle as a spear. These would have been sharp enough to pierce an animal's tough skin.

Sharpened flint tips the spear.



An intricate pattern has been carved into this mammoth bone.



Carved tusk

Mammoth tusks were used for making tools, jewelry, and weapons. This one has been carved with swirling lines that might be a stylized depiction of a human body.

Bone necklaces

This image of a face was carved into a piece of bone. It is one of several sculptures of human faces found at Dolní Věstonice.



The simple lines depict a human face.

Reindeer horns could be used to make tools.



Hunting the herd

As well as mammoths, the people of Dolní Věstonice hunted reindeer as the beasts moved between their summer and winter grazing areas. Some of the meat was preserved for later.

